

Speaker 1 [00:00:00]: First of all, good day. Thank you again for participating in this interview. As we mentioned in the message we sent, we are curious about your views on romantic relationships and would like to gather information about them. Before we start, is this recording okay with you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:17]: Sure, no problem.

Speaker 1 [00:00:19]: Uh-huh. We will only use this recording for transcription, to convert it into notes. First, how old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:00:30]: I am [21-25] years old.

Speaker 1 [00:00:32]: Okay. How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker 2 [00:00:38]: Since [Year].

Speaker 1 [00:00:44]: Do you have any children?

Speaker 2 [00:00:46]: No.

Speaker 1 [00:00:49]: Who do you live with at home?

Speaker 2 [00:00:53]: My mom, dad, and sisters.

Speaker 1 [00:00:59]: What is your main source of income?

Speaker 2 [00:01:01]: My dad and mom's retirement pension.

Speaker 1 [00:01:07]: How would you like us to refer to your partner during this interview? Like boyfriend, spouse, sevgili, etc.

Speaker 2 [00:01:14]: My girlfriend.

Speaker 1 [00:01:21]: Now, I would like you to tell me the story of how you met and when your relationship started.

[Portion Redacted]

Speaker 1 [00:02:31]: How do you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker 2 [00:02:37]: I see ours as higher quality.

Speaker 1 [00:02:45]: Why do you say that? Can you elaborate a bit more?

Speaker 2 [00:02:49]: My friends find it hard to express themselves to their partners, they fear being judged, and there's a lack of complete trust. They even get bored

spending time together. I've never felt that way. I find it strange when someone says they don't want to meet their girlfriend because they find it boring.

Speaker 1 [00:03:18]: How many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker 2 [00:03:22]: [1-5].

Speaker 1 [00:03:22]: How do you rate the quality of your current relationship compared to your previous one?

Speaker 2 [00:03:32]: I was very young then, like in [grade level]. So this current relationship is much more mature and of higher quality. The previous one was just a childhood thing.

Speaker 1 [00:03:50]: What makes a relationship high-quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:03:56]: Being able to have mutual conversations, mutual respect, and enjoying time together.

Speaker 1 [00:04:11]: Can you elaborate on why you said that? Specifically on conversation and enjoyment.

Speaker 2 [00:04:17]: Because, how can I say, life is like that. I think humans need to socialize, and it's enjoyable to spend time with people you care about. The person you love is the most special person, so it should be like that.

Speaker 1 [00:04:44]: By the way, is there a lot of noise coming from my end?

Speaker 2 [00:04:47]: No.

Speaker 1 [00:04:48]: Okay, good. If you want to give more information about the strong concepts you mentioned, like mutual conversation, respect, and enjoyment, I can listen a bit more.

Speaker 2 [00:05:05]: What do you mean?

Speaker 1 [00:05:06]: For example, you said things like mutual conversation, enjoyment, respect, and that people need to socialize. Can you expand a bit on how these contribute to a high-quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:05:23]: For example, it's important that the person I will introduce to my parents is suitable to my family, that my family is suitable for her, and that her family is suitable for me. Sharing the same values and interests are also important.

Speaker 1 [00:05:48]: What are the most important things in a relationship for you?

Speaker 2 [00:05:54]: Trust and respect, those two.

Speaker 1 [00:06:01]: Can you elaborate on why you said that?

Speaker 2 [00:06:06]: Because I believe that trust and respect last a lifetime. This applies not only to romantic relationships but also to normal interpersonal relationships. Love (sevgi) comes third, but trust and respect are necessary to be with someone.

Speaker 1 [00:06:30]: What is aşk to you?

Speaker 2 [00:06:34]: Aşk comes from the essence, from a person's soul. It is related to creation.

Speaker 1 [00:06:48]: How important is aşk in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:06:51]: Very important, I think. Because if you're in aşk, you make time for that person, you create excuses. For example, in class, I used to tease her because I was in aşk. I think it's important.

Speaker 1 [00:07:15]: How do you know your partner loves you?

Speaker 2 [00:07:19]: By her actions, gestures, and looks. I feel the warmth of her heart. It's something different; you just know.

Speaker 1 [00:07:40]: What are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:07:44]: The challenges in our relationship, sorry. One challenge is my girlfriend's father passing away. It still affects her deeply, and I try to support her as much as I can. But knowing I can never fully ease that pain is challenging for me.

Speaker 1 [00:08:21]: Do you and your partner argue?

Speaker 2 [00:08:32]: I don't consider them serious. I don't think they are serious, but she might say we do. Let's say neutral, yes, we argue.

Speaker 1 [00:08:48]: How often do these arguments happen?

Speaker 2 [00:08:52]: Rarely. It's not something that happens frequently.

Speaker 1 [00:08:56]: What are these arguments usually about?

Speaker 2 [00:09:01]: They are usually about me not giving her the attention she thinks she deserves. For example, she might say something, and I might seem like I don't care, but I'm just pretending not to so she can forget about it. That's usually the cause.

Speaker 1 [00:09:34]: How do you resolve these arguments?

Speaker 2 [00:09:38]: We talk about it. She speaks up, or we make a decision together, or I make jokes about it, saying, 'Oh, this is so silly,' and we talk and resolve it.

Speaker 1 [00:09:57]: Besides the solutions you mentioned, like talking, making decisions together, and lightening the mood with jokes, what other ways do you think there are to maintain the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:10:14]: Maintaining a relationship involves respecting each other's life views without imposing them on each other. For example, it's important that my beliefs and hers don't have to match, but we respect each other's differences without letting them come between us.

Speaker 1 [00:10:41]: Do you think this relationship is good for you?

Speaker 2 [00:10:45]: Yes.

Speaker 1 [00:10:48]: Why do you say that?

Speaker 2 [00:10:51]: Because I have often said in bad times that I'm glad I have my girlfriend. For example, in May, I had a blood clot in my brain and spent [1-5] weeks in the hospital. She was there for me every day. In good times, everyone is there, but in bad times, not everyone is. That's why.

Speaker 1 [00:11:23]: Has this relationship changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:25]: It has changed me a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:11:30]: How has it changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:11:32]: I used to drink alcohol a lot, but now I don't drink as much. I was a difficult person to get along with, but now I am more agreeable and focused on enjoying conversations. It has had a positive effect on my life.

Speaker 1 [00:11:59]: What about your partner, has she changed during the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:04]: I think she has. She used to have trouble saying no, but now she can say no more often and stands by her decisions.

Speaker 1 [00:12:35]: Do you think you are the same person you were before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:12:44]: Personally, I think I am the same person, except for the negative parts that I have left behind. I've always loved socializing and talking, and that hasn't changed.

Speaker 1 [00:13:06]: Do you think your partner is the same person she was before the relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:12]: No, I don't think so. I remember her from high school, before we were together. She has gained more confidence since we started the relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:13:26]: Do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:13:37]: Yes, very much.

Speaker 1 [00:13:40]: Can you explain why you feel this way?

Speaker 2 [00:13:43]: Because I don't think about bad things. There's no reason for me to feel otherwise. Despite being a very jealous person, she has never given me a reason to be jealous. There's no problem.

Speaker 1 [00:14:03]: Now we will do something a bit different. Can you see the text on the screen?

Speaker 2 [00:14:14]: Yes, yes, I can see it.

Speaker 1 [00:14:16]: I will ask a few questions this way, and you will answer based on the paper. Now, let me read it. It says, "My partner generally listens to me" below.

Speaker 2 [00:14:36]: Okay.

Speaker 1 [00:14:38]: There is a scale from 1 to 9. If you strongly agree, it's 9. If you strongly disagree, it's 1. Where do you place your answer?

Speaker 2 [00:14:56]: Nine.

Speaker 1 [00:15:06]: Why did you choose 9 and not 8?

Speaker 2 [00:15:14]: Not once did she not listen to me, so it would be unfair to give her anything less than a 9.

Speaker 1 [00:15:40]: Can you give a concrete example of this, like a specific event where she listened to you?

Speaker 2 [00:15:54]: One night, she was about to sleep, already in bed, but I was feeling very bad. She noticed and called me. Whenever I need her, she stops what she's doing and answers the phone. We both do this for each other.

Speaker 1 [00:16:21]: Uh-huh. Now for the next question. Again, from 1 to 9, "My partner is generally sensitive to my needs." 1 for never true, 9 for completely true. What's your answer?

Speaker 2 [00:16:47]: Seven.

Speaker 1 [00:16:49]: Why did you choose this answer?

Speaker 2 [00:16:55]: Because, sorry, usually it's more about what she wants. For example, if we are at a café and I want to sit outside because I smoke, we sit inside because she prefers it. That's why I chose 7.

Speaker 1 [00:17:39]: Now, another question. I hope you don't mind me asking. If this is too personal, please feel free to say so. But we want to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual relations these days?

Speaker 2 [00:17:57]: We've never had any.

Speaker 1 [00:18:04]: How satisfied are you with your sexual life?

Speaker 2 [00:18:08]: Honestly, to be satisfied or not, I would need to have experienced something first. So I can't say for sure. But sometimes I do wish for more, but I respect her boundaries.

Speaker 1 [00:18:42]: I'll show you another paper on the screen. It reads, "How satisfied are you with your relationship overall?" Options range from completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:18:59]: Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:19:09]: Why did you give this answer?

Speaker 2 [00:19:12]: Based on what I feel, think, and see, I already knew I was completely satisfied even before you asked. My close and trusted friends also tell me they admire our relationship. This reassures me that my feelings are right.

Speaker 1 [00:19:44]: There's another question here that might not be visible. It asks how you would rate your relationship satisfaction on a scale from -10 to +10, with 0 being neutral.

Speaker 2 [00:20:22]: Can you repeat that?

Speaker 1 [00:20:24]: Sure. How satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:20:29]: Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:20:32]: What numerical value would you give, from -10 to +10?

Speaker 2 [00:20:37]: Ten, plus ten.

Speaker 1 [00:20:39]: Why did you give this answer?

Speaker 2 [00:20:59]: Because I am truly satisfied with the relationship. It's like in the previous questions; when I look at it cumulatively, it makes sense. I also want to give you a specific example. God willing, she's the person I want to marry. I enjoy every moment with her, like the saying goes, "I'd even eat plain bread with her." That's why I'm completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:21:38]: Why didn't you give a 9 instead of 10?

Speaker 2 [00:21:46]: Because I feel immense gratitude for this relationship. I thank God every day for being with her, so it's a ten out of ten for me.

Speaker 1 [00:22:06]: Uh-huh. We are about to finish. Let me quickly summarize what we discussed. You are [21-25] years old and have been in this relationship since [Year].

You don't have any children and live with your parents and sisters. Your main source of income is your [source]. You refer to your partner as your girlfriend. [Portion Redacted] You rate your relationship higher than others because your friends can't express themselves easily or fear being judged, while your relationship is more open and trusting. You've had [1-5] previous romantic relationship, but it was when you were very young, and you now consider your current relationship much more mature. What makes a relationship high-quality for you is mutual conversation, respect, and enjoyment. You believe humans need to socialize, and the person you love is the most special person. It's important that your partner is suitable to introduce to your family and vice versa. The most important things in a relationship for you are trust and respect, which you believe last a lifetime, with love coming third. Aşk, for you, comes from the essence, from a person's soul, and it's very important in a relationship because it makes you make time and excuses for the person. You know your partner loves you by her actions, gestures, looks, and the warmth of her heart. The challenge in your relationship is dealing with your girlfriend's father's passing, and you try to support her as best as you can. You and your partner argue rarely, and the arguments are usually because she feels you don't pay attention to her. You resolve arguments by talking, making decisions together, or lightening the mood with jokes. Besides these, you believe maintaining a relationship involves respecting each other's views without imposing them. You said this relationship is good for you because your girlfriend is there for you in bad times, like when you were hospitalized for [1-5] weeks. The relationship has changed you; you drink less alcohol and are easier to get along with now. Your partner has also changed; she used to have trouble saying no, but now she can stand by her decisions. You are still the same person, except for the negative parts you've left behind. Your partner, however, has gained more confidence. You rated "My partner generally listens to me" as 9 because anything less would be unfair. You gave the example of her talking to you even when she was about to sleep. You rated "My partner is generally sensitive to my needs" as 7 because usually, it's more about what she wants. For example, you sit inside a café because she prefers it. You haven't had any sexual relations, so you can't say you're satisfied or not. Sometimes you wish for more, but you respect her boundaries. You are completely satisfied with your relationship overall and rated it as +10 because you feel immense gratitude for being with her. Is there anything I said that you would like to correct or add?

Speaker 2 [00:28:00]: No, everything is correct. Thank you.

Speaker 1 [00:28:02]: Okay, now we are at the final part. Thank you very much for participating in our study. Before we finish, I want to talk about how we will handle the data. As a research project, we want to be as transparent as possible. Therefore, we want to know which sharing option you find most suitable. The first option is to share some parts of the transcript of our interview. These parts will not contain any information that can identify you, so an anonymized transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option is, if you don't mind and want to be a bit more bold, to share the entire transcript, also anonymized and stripped of overly identifying details. This way, someone who knows you well might have a slight chance of narrowing down who you are among their colleagues, but it's very unlikely. Again, no sensitive information will be shared. Which option do you choose?

Speaker 2 [00:29:06]: The one without my name.

Speaker 1 [00:29:08]: You choose the first option. Thank you again for contributing to this study. This study is also being conducted in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France, and the United States. For this study to be successful, we need to reach a diverse range of participants. If it's okay with you, can you suggest two close people in your life as candidates? We will ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study, preferably those you don't know and haven't interacted with. This way, we can reach a diverse range of participants. Is this suitable for you?

Speaker 2 [00:29:45]: It's not something I can promise, they might not agree.

Speaker 1 [00:29:49]: Okay. That's all, thank you. Let me stop the recording.